

Word Order & Articles

Guided Discovery & Comprehensible Input
(90–100 Minutes Online)



Inductive Approach



Duration: 90 – 100 Minutes



SVO, SVIO, SVOP,
Articles & Modifiers

Phase 1: Warm-up Discussion

"Where do you prefer to study or read? Why?"



Option A: University Library

"I prefer the library because it provides a quiet and peaceful environment."



Option B: Local Coffee Shop

"I like studying in a café because background noise helps my creativity."



Option C: Home Study Desk

"I usually study at home because it is comfortable and convenient."



Phase 2: Reading Context

Finding the Ideal Study Environment

Many international students look for quiet places on campus. Maya is a hardworking student at an Australian university. She usually studies in the main library because it provides a peaceful environment. However, when she has complex projects, she sends her classmates a message to meet at a local café.

Yesterday, she carefully wrote a long essay there. The café serves delicious coffee, and friendly staff always welcome guests warmly. Does a noisy environment distract students? Some researchers recently studied this question. They found that moderate background noise actually boosts creativity. Maya often visits this café early in the morning, and she completes her assignments successfully.

- Comprehension Check:**
1. What is Maya's favorite study spot?
 2. What did researchers discover?

Phase 3: Color-Coded Noticing

Analyze the highlighted sentence structures in the reading passage:



Blue: S-V-O Skeleton

Identifies basic clause blocks: Subject + Verb + Object.

Example: She wrote a long essay

A

Green: Articles (A/An/The)

Identifies determiners placing bound markers before adjectives and nouns.

Example: a peaceful environment



Yellow: Modifiers

Identifies placement of descriptive adjectives and frequency/manner adverbs.

Example: usually studies / carefully wrote



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Rule 1: SVO & Question Order

→ Standard Word Order (SVO)

Standard English sentences follow a strict linear sequence where the action verb directly connects to its object.

- ✓ **Subject + Verb + Object**
- ✓ Example: *"Maya completes her assignments."*

Formula: [Subject] + [Verb] + [Object]

? Yes/No Questions (ASVO)

Questions require an Auxiliary verb placed BEFORE the subject while keeping main action order intact.

- ✓ **Auxiliary + Subject + Verb + Object**
- ✓ Example: *"Does a noisy environment distract students?"*

Formula: [Aux (Do/Does)] + [Subject] + [Verb] + [Object]

Rule 2: Objects & Prepositions

Two Objects (SVIO)

When a verb takes both a person and a thing, the person (Direct Object) sits before the thing (Indirect Object).

✓ **Person BEFORE Thing:** *"She sends her classmates a message."*

✓ **Alternative:** *"She sends a message to her classmates."*

Formula: S + V + Indirect Object (Person) + Direct Object (Thing)

Prepositional Phrases (SVOP)

Location or place phrases are placed AFTER the indirect object, not between verb and object.

✓ **Correct:** *"She wrote a long essay in the cafe/there."*

✗ **Incorrect:** *"She wrote in the café a long essay."*

Formula: Subject + Verb + Object + [Place Phrase]

🔑 Rules 3 & 4: Modifiers & Articles

A Articles & Adjective Order

Articles (a/an/the) precede adjectives, and adjectives sit right before the noun they describe.

- ✓ **Article + Adjective + Noun**
- ✓ Example: "*a hardworking student*", "*the peaceful environment*"
- ✓ After stative verbs: "*The staff are friendly.*"

🕒 Adverb Placement Rules

Adverb placement depends strictly on whether it modifies frequency, manner, or time.

- ✓ **Frequency (usually/always):** Between Subject & Main Verb.
- ✓ **Manner (carefully/warmly):** After Verb or Object.
- ✓ **Time Phrases (yesterday):** Beginning or end of clause.

Adjective Placement Rules

A

Position 1: Before Nouns

Adjectives sit directly before the noun they modify: "*small school*", "*useful books*", "*young volunteer*".

🔗

Position 2: After Stative / Linking Verbs

Place adjectives after linking verbs (*be, feel, seem, look*): "*The school **is** old*", "*Amara **feels** proud*".

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Important Constraint

Never place an adjective between the verb and its direct object. ❌ *She bought new the desks.*

Adverb Placement Rules (Part 1)



Modifying Adjectives/Adverbs

Place degree adverbs directly **before** the target word.

- *very* early
- *very* old



Modifying Verbs (Manner)

Place manner adverbs **after** the verb or object.

- learn *quickly*
- listen *carefully*



Core Strict Rule

Never split a verb and its object with an adverb.

✗ She speaks fluently English.
✓ She speaks English *fluently*.

Adverb Placement Rules (Part 2)

Adverbs of Frequency

always, usually, often, rarely, never

- Position: **Before main verbs**, but **after** the verb *'be'*.
- She *usually* **teaches** English.
- The children **are** *always* cheerful.

Adverbs of Time

every morning, last year, today, now

- Position: At the **end** of the clause (standard) or **beginning** (for emphasis).
- She stays at school *until six o'clock*.
- *Every morning*, she wakes up early.

Discovery Rules Summary

Structure / Pattern	Grammar Formula	Text Example
Standard Statement	Subject + Verb + Object	Amara teaches English.
Direct Question	Auxiliary + Subject + Verb	Do you enjoy your job?
Double Object	Verb + Person + Thing	She gives students useful books.
Adverb of Frequency	Subject + Adv + Main Verb	She usually teaches math.
Adverb of Manner	Verb + Object + Adverb	The children learn quickly.

Phase 5: Exercise

1 Exercise A — Sentence Unscramble:

Reorder: (*wrote / a helpful email / to her professor / yesterday / Maya*)

2 Exercise B — Question Formation:

Reorder: (*a / quiet / does / require / study space / concentration / ?*)

3 Exercise C — Modifier Insertion:

Insert '**often**' into: "*Maya reads articles in the library.*"

4 Exercise D — Error Correction:

Identify error: "*Maya sends to her teacher an essay.*"

✓ Answers

Task	Correct Answer	Grammatical Explanation
Ex A: Unscramble	<i>"Maya wrote a helpful email to her professor yesterday."</i>	Follows S + V + Direct Obj + Prep Phrase + Time adverbial at the end.
Ex B: Question	<i>"Does a quiet study space require concentration?"</i>	ASVO structure: Aux (Does) + Subject (a quiet study space) + Verb + Obj.
Ex C: Insertion	<i>"Maya often reads articles in the library."</i>	Frequency adverbs sit directly between Subject and Main Verb.
Ex D: Error Fix	<i>"Maya sends her teacher an essay."</i>	Indirect Object (person) precedes Direct Object (thing) without 'to'.

Common Errors & Fixes

Anticipated Error	Student Example	Handling Strategy
Direct Object Separated	<i>"She wrote yesterday an essay."</i>	An action verb must touch its direct object.
Post-Noun Adjective	<i>"She studies in a library quiet."</i>	[Adj] + [Noun] formula ("quiet library") vs linking verbs.
Incorrect Indirect Obj	<i>"She sends to her teacher an essay."</i>	V + Person + Thing OR V + Thing + TO + Person.
Misplaced Frequency Adverb	<i>"She studies usually in café."</i>	Frequency adverbs "hug" the subject before main verb.

Phase 6: Writing Task

Writing Prompt:

Describe a place where you like to study or work.

-  Where it is located (*prepositional phrases*)
-  What it looks like (*articles & adjectives*)
-  How often you go (*frequency adverbs*)
-  What you do there (*SVO / SVIO*)



